

ANCHORED BY THE SABBATH

Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy. (Exodus 20:8)

FOR FAMILY WORSHIP: Pages 48-50

FURTHER STUDY FOR PARENTS: Pages 51-53

WHERE DOES OUR IDENTITY REST?

The desert was quiet in a new way. No Egyptian whistle cut the air. No brick master shouted, "Faster!" No one counted how many bricks were made before sunset. For the first time in generations, Israel was not being pushed by someone else's demands. Then God gave them a command that sounded like a gift wrapped in time: "Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy" (Exodus 20:8).

The word remember was not only about keeping a day on the calendar. It was about remembering who they were. Identity means the truth about us before we do anything, win anything, post anything, or prove anything. Israel belonged to God because He created them, rescued them, loved them, and called them His children.

We belong to God too. We are His before we get everything right, before we feel brave, and before we know what tomorrow will bring. In a

VUCA WORLD, where life can feel changing, confusing, busy, and unclear, Sabbath helps us hear God's voice again. It says, "You are not a slave to screens, buzzing messages, or trying to prove you are special. You are My child."

Sabbath also teaches us how to put first things first. That means choosing what matters most and giving it the best place in our day. Imagine big rocks and sand. If the sand goes into the jar first, the rocks will not fit. But if the big rocks go first, the sand fills the spaces. God, family, worship, rest, and love are the big rocks. Screens, games, and busy things must not push them out.

Think of Sabbath as God's reset button for the heart. It does not erase us. It brings us back to what is true. We reconnect with God, worship, wonder, people we love, creation, and the joy of being alive in His care.

Today, we stop because God is enough. We rest because we are His, and His love holds each one of us.

READ

ASK

FAMILY PRAYER

Put devices away, hold hands, and pray: **"Dear God, help us rest, remember we are Yours, and reconnect with what matters. In Jesus' name, amen."**

The world for newly liberated people was like this:

VOLATILE: No longer slaves, learning freedom.

UNCERTAIN: Desert days, daily food uncertain.

COMPLEX: New rules, new family ways.

AMBIGUOUS: Learning to live truly free.

With God's promise of the Sabbath, we can:

VENTURE: God helps us live free.

UNVEIL: Remember we are God's children.

COMPASS: Sabbath shows what matters.

ASSURANCE: We can rest in God.

The Israelites were no longer in Egypt, but Egypt still wanted their slaves. In a **VUCA WORLD**, the Sabbath reminds us that we are God's children, not slaves to work, screens, or pressure—and children can rest.

1 Read
Exodus 20:8–11
together

2 Underline
the word
“remember”

3 Ask yourself:

- Is rest just more entertainment?
- Do screens help me rest?

This story helps us remember that God made us His children, not busy little workers. **I promise to help our family slow down, put screens in their place, and enjoy Sabbath rest with God and each other.**

FAMILY ACTIVITY: The Sabbath Pause Button

Use a TV remote as the “pause button.” Place it in the middle of the family. Each person presses it and names a screen activity to pause on the Sabbath. Then choose a quiet joy instead: a walk, Bible story, drawing, game, or family talk. Ask: “What can God help us notice when screens are quiet?” **Pray and thank God for rest and peace together today.**



FURTHER STUDY FOR PARENTS:

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Today's Principle: Sabbath Freedom

Today's Promise for your home is peaceful and free:
Sabbath says we are His children, not slaves.

This parent reflection helps you see Sabbath as God's weekly gift of freedom. In a loud **VUCA WORLD**, you will learn how rest teaches identity, quiets digital noise, and helps your home remember again: we are God's children, not machines.

V VENTURE BEYOND FEAR IN A VOLATILE WORLD

The promise for your home is this: Sabbath can teach your family to live like God's children, not like people who must always prove they matter. In a world that keeps saying, "Do more, show more, answer faster, and stay connected," Sabbath says, "Rest. You belong to God."

For parents, this is more than a pause. It is a way to reshape the heart of the home. Screens, schedules, schoolwork, messages, and responsibilities can train a family to feel valuable when something is finished, posted, liked, or achieved. Sabbath breaks that pattern. It reminds us that our worth is not measured by output, attention, or applause.

Israel had to learn this after Egypt. Freedom was not only leaving slavery behind; it was learning not to live with a slave's heart. God said, "Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy" (Exodus 20:8, NKJV), because rest teaches identity.

ASK YOURSELF: AM I TEACHING MY FAMILY TO LIVE AS GOD'S FREE CHILDREN, OR AS PEOPLE WHO ALWAYS NEED TO PROVE THEIR WORTH?

U UNVEIL DEEPER TRUTH IN UNCERTAIN TIMES

Read Exodus 20:8–11. Underline the word remember. God gave Sabbath so His people would not forget who they were: free children, not slaves who had to keep making bricks to prove their worth.

Parents can forget too. Screens can whisper, “Create more. Post more. Reply faster. Keep showing you matter.” Soon rest becomes more scrolling, more videos, more reacting, and our hearts stay busy instead of free.

ASK YOURSELF: WHAT HELPS ME REMEMBER I AM GOD’S CHILD? DOES SABBATH HELP OUR HOME REST, OR STAY STIRRED UP? SABBATH TEACHES US TO STOP PRODUCING AND SIMPLY BE WITH GOD AGAIN.

C COMPASS THAT REMAINS STEADY THROUGH COMPLEXITY

Educational principles from Ellen White help us see the Sabbath as more than a rule to keep. The Sabbath is a weekly teacher. It teaches the heart to remember who God is, who we are, and what kind of home we are building. Ellen White wrote, ***“The Sabbath and the family were alike instituted in Eden,” and added that God preserves this day for the family to have “communion with Him, with nature, and with one another”*** (Education, p. 250).

After six days of working, answering messages, organizing schedules, solving problems, and trying to keep up, Sabbath gently says, Stop and remember. Your worth is not measured by how much you finish. Your child’s worth is not measured by grades, chores, talents, posts, or praise. You are God’s children before you do anything for anyone.

This is why Sabbath keeping is a lifestyle, not only a day on the calendar. It involves worship, rest, family connection, joyful service, time in nature, meals, unhurried conversation, and turning away from the noise that keeps the mind running. It creates a safe space where the phone does not lead the family, notifications do not interrupt love, and screens do not decide the mood of the home.

For Israel, the Sabbath was a lesson in freedom. They were no longer slaves in Egypt. Today, Sabbath can teach a similar freedom. We are not slaves to the algorithm. We are not slaves to constant availability. We are not slaves to producing more. Healthy limits are not walls that trap us; they are doors that open peace.

Sabbath reminds the family that God is enough, love is near, and rest is obedience.

REST IS NOT DISCONNECTION FROM LIFE; IT IS RECONNECTION WITH GOD, FAMILY, AND WHAT MATTERS MOST.

A ASSURANCE THAT STANDS FIRM AMID AMBIGUITY

Before Sabbath begins, try the **SABBATH RESET PLAN**. Parents, choose together what your home will pause for 24 hours: no social media, no shorts or reels, no intense video games, and devices only for essential communication. Explain it gently to the children: this is not punishment; it is practice for freedom.

Then prepare simple joys to fill the quiet: a walk in nature, slow reading, deep conversation, a board game, or creative worship. Notice the first restless feelings without fear. The mind may ask for noise at first, but Sabbath teaches the heart to breathe, listen, and trust again.

AT THE END, ASK: WHAT CHANGED IN OUR MINDS, AND WHAT DID WE DISCOVER WHEN SCREENS BECAME QUIET?



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Sabbath teaches us to stop chasing noise and trust God. In a **VUCA WORLD**, rest reminds us: we are not slaves to screens—we are God's beloved children.